

Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Twenty-First Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 23rd August 2026

Parish Clergy

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Thoughts on the Gospel (*Matthew 14:13-21*)

In today's gospel, Jesus asks His disciples a very personal question about who they believe He is. Many people had different opinions about Him, but Jesus wanted His followers to speak from their own faith and experience. Peter answers with confidence, recognising Jesus as the promised Saviour and the Son of God.

This passage reminds us that faith cannot depend only on what others believe. We may learn about God from our parents, teachers, friends or church community, but each of us must eventually make our own response to Jesus. The word **ROCK** helps us remember the message. We are called to **RECOGNISE** Jesus as Lord and Saviour, **OWN** our faith through daily choices, **COMMIT** to the calling God gives us, and **KEEP** standing firm when life becomes difficult.

Peter was not perfect, yet Jesus still used him for a great purpose. In the same way, God can work through our weaknesses and help us become part of His mission. When we build our lives on Christ, our faith becomes stronger, our hope grows deeper, and our lives show the answer to Jesus' question. Our response should not be seen only in our words, but also in how we love, forgive, serve, and remain faithful. Christ is the true foundation, and when we stand on Him, life's storms may shake us, but they cannot destroy the hope He gives.

Lord Jesus, you are the Messiah, the Son of the living God. Strengthen our faith to confess You with courage. May nothing overcome the hope we have in You.

Camus / Leckpatrick Parish Draw is on Thursday 27th August at 7.30 pm in the Parochial House, Ballymagorry. Outstanding payments can be made to your promoter or at pastoral office. Good luck everyone and thanks for all the support.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Patrick's Hall every Thursday at 8.00 pm for bingo and lucky four. Come along for some fun and excitement and of course slight competition.

Donegal Down Syndrome Association Annual Church Gate Collection takes place on 29th/30th August at St Patrick's Murlog. Anyone interested in helping can contact info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or 0857870075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down syndrome and their families across Donegal. Thank you.

Embrace the Grace Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference on Saturday 29th August from 9.30 am – 6 pm at De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03. Tickets from www.eventbrite. Search Embrace the Grace.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of

John Duncan, Church View, Strabane

Michael (Mixer) McCrossan, Marian Park, Strabane

Jane Friel, Drumbuoy, Lifford

Anthony McGillian, Innisfree Gardens, Strabane

Stephen Hannigan, Castleview, Newtownstewart

Gerard McShane, Belfast / Strabane

Anniversaries Paul Bradley, Columba Burns, Packie Conwell, Davy Crotty, Agnes Deazley, Elizabeth Devine, Dennis Devlin, Rosaleen Doherty, Gillian Gallagher, Moya Gallagher, Philomena Gallagher, James Houston, Sr Magdalene Joyce, Harry Kielty, Michael (Micky) Lynn, Mary McConnell, Agnes McCosker, George McCosker, Ken McCrory, Arthur McDaid, Edward McDaid, Patsy McElroy (Snr), Susan McGinnis, George McLaughlin, Joan McNulty, Tommy Melaugh, Jim Montague, Betty O'Doherty, Kathleen Tinney

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,509.91

Clonleigh: €1,257.95

Camus: £1,784.29

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 30th August:

1st Reading: Jeremiah 20:7-9

Psalm: 62:2-6,8-9

2nd Reading: Romans 12:1-2

Gospel: Matthew 16:21-27

Saints of The Coming Week:

Monday: St Bartholomew, Apostle

Tuesday: St Joseph Calasanz, priest; St Louis

Thursday: St Monica

Friday: St Augustine, bishop & doctor of the Church

Saturday: The Passion of St John the Baptist, martyr

Encounter School of Ministry Course is launching in All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham in Sept. This course draws from the richness of our Catholic heritage as we seek to teach, equip, and activate disciples to demonstrate the love of God through the power of the Holy Spirit in their spheres of influence. Please email donegal@encounterschool.org to attend or visit www.encounterschool.org

Derry Diocesan Trust Job Opportunity Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hrs pw), Waterside Parish, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 – £13.50 per hour. Please contact recruitment@derrydiocese.org or 028 71262302. Closing date: 24/8/26.

Personal Assistants Wanted The Churches Trust is recruiting people for flexible part time work supporting and befriending elderly people living independently at home. No experience required – training and support provided. Full clean driving licence and access to a vehicle is required. For more information, call 02871 311322.

Medjugorje Pilgrimage 23rd – 30th Sept. Cost: £775 pps. Dublin – Dubrovnik return. Single room £150. Call Anne 07736005396 to book / details.

NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Kilfennan Presbyterian Church, Rosstown Rd, Derry, BT47 6FP on Monday 7th September from 12.30 pm – 4.00 pm & 5.00 pm – 7.00 pm. Please freecall 08085534653 to book.

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw to ensure Station Island remains open for future generations. Single ticket: €10. Book of 6: €50. Buy a full book and you're entered into a sellers' draw. Return a complete book for Early Bird draw on 28/8/26. Tickets from www.loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw or +353 (0) 719861518 or info@loughderg.org Draw date: 23/10/26.

Moneyglass Bowling Club will hold their singles tournament at Moneyglass Community Centre, 10 Loughbeg Rd, Toomebridge, BT41 3TN from 31st August – 5th September at 7.30 pm. Final on 5th September. To enter, contact Henry on 07784286048 or 028 79650382 or henrymarron65@gmail.com All welcome.

Gamblers Anonymous Tel 71351329. **Alcoholics Anonymous** Tel 90351222.

Please Pray for Vocations Visit <https://derryvocations.org>

Sharing the Good News Visit <https://theway.ie/ezone-2/> for the weekly ezine.

Family Carers Ireland are running 1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home. Contact 0868363842 or Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Lough Derg Day Retreats August 29 & 31; Sept 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20. Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg. Visit www.loughderg.org

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation Course for those getting married in late 2026 / early 2027. You can register online at www.accordni.com Next dates are September 25th/26th 2026 & November 20th/21st 2026. Please note that Accord Derry will NOT be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Marriage Enrichment Weekend Marriage Encounter invites married couples to a residential weekend from 2nd – 4th October at the Focolare Centre, Prosperous, Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

St Joseph's Men's Camino 2026 A Day of pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal on Saturday 12th September. Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ alongside other Catholic men. Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, St Joseph Men's Camino is a 25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley Camino. Open to men aged 18 and over. Cost €65 (includes lunch @ dinner). Students: €55. Visit www.dominicans.ie

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice Join us on Friday 25th September from 9.30am – 12.30pm at Murphy's on the Green. Prize draw: £1 per line. All welcome.

Michael English Church Concert – An Evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration on Friday 2nd Oct at 7.15 pm in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets (£30) available at Heron's Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena PO, Ballinascreen, Desertmartin Parish or from: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Buncrana Annual Garden Fete today (Sunday) from 3 – 6 pm in grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Buncrana, F93 PN53. Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes, etc. Entry €5pp / €15 per family (cash only). All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day takes place on Sunday 6th September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry, beginning with the National Mass at 2 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For information / to book, please email info@catholicmothers.ie All welcome.

RISE A vital new community initiative, RISE is dedicated to supporting the families, friends, and loved ones of those living with addiction. A gathering takes place on Sunday 13th Sept – 12 noon – 4 pm in Everglades Hotel, Derry, aiming to bring together people who may feel isolated, overwhelmed, or unaware of the support structures available to them as they navigate a loved one's addiction. The foundational message of RISE is that recovery and healing involve the whole family. The day is designed to serve as a safe, welcoming space where people can share experiences, build meaningful connections, and discover where they can turn for help. To secure your place, send a direct message via facebook messenger to the official page.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Alzheimer's Society is running a Carers' Information Support Programme (CRISP) for family, carers and friends of people living with dementia in Omagh area. The programme is run over 2 sessions; attendees should attend both afternoons. Dates: 7th and 8th September 2026 3-5pm In the Conference Room, Silver Birch Hotel, 5 Gortin Road, Omagh. To register, please contact Julie-Anne, Senior Dementia Adviser. M:07889 604702. Registration is required prior to attendance.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (23rd August – alternate Sundays – 6th Sept)

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (30th Aug – alternate Sundays – 13th Sept)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes. **Office hours:** Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am – 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am – 12.30 pm. Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.